Aider — Configuration Report

Prepared for **Murpheux** · 28 September 2026 · Verified against **Aider v0.86.2** (latest release; main 0.86.3.dev)
Folder: `~/agent-configs/aider/` → installs to `~/.aider.conf.yml` and `~/.aider/`

1. Summary

Upstream Aider has a single agent loop. It has **no subagents, hooks, MCP or custom slash commands**; the `cecli` fork adds them. The OpenCode design was mapped onto Aider's native levers:

- **model tiers**: main, weak (commit messages and history summaries), editor, and architect mode;
- **aliases and wrappers** as the router;
- `/load` **command files** as workflows;
- **read-only skill files** loaded on demand;
- Aider's own **safety options**.

The most important security fix: Aider commits with `--no-verify` by default, which silently skips the ggshield pre-commit hook. This config turns verification on.

7	5	24	20	9
tiered entry points	model settings	/load files	skills	linters

2. Sources used

- `Aider-AI/aider` source and docs: the config search order, options/args, advanced model settings, reasoning, caching, lint-test, git, openai-compat, OpenRouter, `sample.aider.conf.yml` and HISTORY.
- Community (no awesome list was provided): Aider-AI/conventions, ai-repository-security-baseline (`.aiderignore`), dbatools.ai (PowerShell), cecli, aider-desk, aider-mcp-server, bradAGI/awesome-cli-coding-agents.

3. What was built

File	Purpose
`~/.aider.conf.yml`	models and aliases; gateway base URL; TLS through the full system CA bundle; cache/repo-map/history budgets; the conventions file; git safety; per-language lint; safety options
`~/.aider/model.settings.yml`	per-model edit format, weak/editor models, `cache_control`, reasoning passthrough (`accepts_settings`), `max_tokens` caps, and OpenRouter `data_collection: deny`
`~/.aider/model.metadata.json`	context limits and prices (placeholders), so `/tokens` and the cost report work for gateway models
`~/.aider/CONVENTIONS.md`	full global instructions, read-only and prompt-cached
`~/.aider/aider-aliases.sh`	`ai`, `ai-ask`, `ai-cheap`, `ai-arch`, `ai-review`, `ai-sec`, `ai-sre`. All start through `op run --env-file ~/.aider/aider.op.env`
`~/.aider/commands/*.cmds`	`review`, `security-review`, `plan`, `commit-check`, plus 20 `skill-<id>.cmds` loaders
`~/.aider/skills/`, `bin/lint-go`, `templates/.aiderignore`	skills; a package-level Go lint wrapper; the per-repo secrets ignore file

4. Routing (aliases = router)

Command	Mode · model	Use
`ai-ask`	ask · `openai/deepseek-flash` · effort low	SIMPLE questions, exploration
`ai-cheap`	code · deepseek-flash · repo map 512	trivial edits
`ai`	code · `openai/claude-sonnet-5` · medium	NORMAL development
`ai-arch`	architect · `openrouter/openai/gpt-6-sol` plans → sonnet applies	COMPLEX / EXPERT
`ai-review` · `ai-sec`	ask · deepseek-flash · `openrouter/anthropic/claude-opus-5.5`	diff review · HIGH_RISK security review

5. Cost levers

- `cache-prompts` caches the system prompt, conventions and repo map, and requires `cache_control` per model.
- `cache-keepalive-pings: 0`, because pings cost money.
- `map-tokens: 1024` and `max-chat-history-tokens: 6000`; old turns are summarised by the weak model.
- `auto-test: false`, because failing output is re-sent up to 3 times; the per-repo `test-cmd` examples pipe through `tail`.
- Reasoning effort only reaches the main model; `max_tokens` caps are set per model; aliases pick the cheapest tier.
- Aider never enforces budgets, so put spend limits on the LiteLLM virtual key.

6. Security

- **Commits**: `git-commit-verify: true` runs ggshield and other hooks; `dirty-commits: false` never sweeps in your uncommitted work; signing follows `commit.gpgsign`.
- **Shell**: `suggest-shell-commands: false`, `yes-always: false` — nothing runs unless you type `/run` or confirm.
- **Context**:
  - `detect-urls: false` keeps untrusted web content out;
  - `add-gitignore-files: false`;
  - the `.aiderignore` template covers env files, keys, state, kube/cloud configs;
  - `gitignore: false` stops Aider editing each repo's `.gitignore`.
- **Credentials**: injected per process by `op run`. The reference file is *not* named `~/.env`, because Aider auto-loads that with override and would replace the real keys with `op://` literals.
- **TLS**: `verify-ssl: true`, with `SSL_CERT_FILE` / `REQUESTS_CA_BUNDLE` pointing at the full OS bundle, not at the home-lab CA alone.

7. Gotchas handled

- **Lists never merge**: a repo-level `read:` replaces the global one, so the README shows repeating it.
- **Paths**: `~` expands only in `read`, so settings and metadata paths are absolute, rendered per machine by the installer.
- **Lint keys**: `lint-cmd` entries are quoted with grep-ast language keys (`csharp`, `hcl`, `powershell`, `bash`, `dockerfile`).
- **OpenRouter OAuth**: Aider would store the key in plain text; the aliases supply `OPENROUTER_API_KEY` so this never triggers.
- **Untrusted repos**: their `.aider.conf.yml` / `.env` can set commands or the API base — inspect them first.

8. Validation

YAML and json5 files parse. The installer smoke test showed the config rendering with absolute paths for the temp HOME, 20 skills and 24 loaders installed, and `aider.op.env` at mode 0600. The conventions file retains all 277 checked items. Aider isn't installed here, so there was no live run.

9. Install

```
uv tool install --force --python python3.12 --with pip aider-chat@latest
cd ~/agent-configs/aider && DRY_RUN=1 ./install.sh && ./install.sh
echo 'source ~/.aider/aider-aliases.sh' >> ~/.zshrc
ggshield install --mode local          # per repo; plus copy templates/.aiderignore
```